

Return Material Authorisation (RMA) Process

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1. Scope

This procedure describes how customers and partners return Halcyon, Tessera and Lumen products to Meridian Instruments for repair, warranty replacement or evaluation. No product may be returned without a valid Return Material Authorisation (RMA) number. Shipments that arrive without an RMA number are refused at goods-in.

2. Requesting an RMA

1. Log in to the Meridian Support Centre (MSC) portal at support.meridian-instruments.com.
 2. Open, or locate, the MSC ticket describing the fault. Every RMA must be linked to an MSC ticket, for example MSC-2025-018842. RMA requests without a linked ticket are rejected.
 3. From the ticket, select Request RMA and enter the serial numbers, the fault description, any error code shown (for example E-117, T-327 or L-222) and the return address.
 4. For claims involving physical damage (cracked housings, damaged flanges, broken antenna connectors), attach at least two photographs showing the damage and the serial number label.
 5. The RMA desk approves the request within 1 business day and issues an RMA number in the format RMA-YYYY-NNNNNN, for example RMA-2025-004127, together with the shipping label.
 6. One RMA number covers up to 10 units of the same model with the same fault.
- The rma@meridian-instruments.com mailbox is no longer monitored for new requests and sends an automatic reply directing customers to the portal.

3. Validity

An RMA number is valid for 21 days from issue. Units received after 21 days are held for 10 business days and then returned unrepaired at the customer's cost unless the RMA is renewed in the portal.

4. Returns addresses

Customer region | Returns location

United Kingdom | Meridian Instruments Ltd, Service Centre, Leeds, United Kingdom

European Union and rest of Europe (non-UK) | Meridian Instruments B.V., EU Returns Hub, Rotterdam, Netherlands

Middle East and Africa | Meridian Instruments Ltd, Service Centre, Leeds, United Kingdom

North, Central and South America | Meridian Instruments Inc., Service Centre, Austin, Texas, United States

Asia-Pacific | Meridian Instruments Sdn Bhd, Service Centre, Penang, Malaysia

The Rotterdam hub removes customs delays for EU customers after the UK's exit from the EU. Units needing component-level repair may be forwarded from Rotterdam to Leeds; this does not change the turnaround commitment.

Write the RMA number clearly on the outside of every carton. Pack gas detectors with their battery installed but switched off. Lumen flow meters must be drained, dried and shipped with flange protection covers fitted.

5. Decontamination declaration (mandatory)

Every return must include a completed and signed Decontamination Declaration, form MI-F-031, both uploaded to the RMA in the portal and placed in a clear pouch on the outside of the carton. The form confirms which substances the product was exposed to and how it was cleaned.

Units that arrive without form MI-F-031 are quarantined unopened and returned to the customer at the customer's cost. This applies to warranty returns too.

6. Advance replacement

Advance replacement is available to Professional and Premier support customers (see sup-sla-tiers). Premier replacements ship on the next business day after RMA approval. The faulty unit must be received within 21 days of the replacement being delivered, or the replacement unit is invoiced at list price.

7. Assessment and turnaround

On receipt, the service centre inspects the unit and classifies the return as:

- Warranty repair or replacement at no charge, under the warranty terms in force when the product was purchased (see sup-warranty-terms-2025).
- Chargeable repair, for which a quotation is posted to the MSC ticket and must be approved within 15 business days.
- No fault found, which carries an inspection fee of GBP 95 (EUR 110, USD 120, MYR 550) for units outside warranty.

The target turnaround is 10 business days from receipt to dispatch for warranty repairs and from quotation approval for chargeable repairs. Status updates are posted to the linked MSC ticket at each stage: Received, In assessment, Awaiting approval, In repair, Dispatched. Halcyon instruments are returned with a fresh calibration certificate. Tessera gateways are reset to factory defaults and returned with the current gateway firmware, 5.3.0.

8. Shipping costs

For warranty returns, Meridian pays inbound shipping using the portal-generated label and pays outbound shipping. For chargeable repairs, the customer pays inbound shipping and outbound shipping is added to the quotation.

9. Changes from the previous version

Item | Version 1 (February 2024) | Version 2 (April 2025)

How to request | Email to rma@meridian-instruments.com | MSC portal, linked MSC ticket required

RMA number format | RMA-24-NNNNN | RMA-YYYY-NNNNNN

RMA validity | 30 days | 21 days

EU (non-UK) returns | Leeds | Rotterdam EU Returns Hub

Decontamination declaration | Recommended | Mandatory, form MI-F-031; units without it quarantined and returned at customer cost

Photos for damage claims | Not required | At least two photos required

Advance replacement | Premier only | Professional and Premier

Target turnaround | 15 business days | 10 business days